

BOARD OF DIRECTORS

About Our Board

Comprised of teachers, parents, and community friends, our Board of Directors is dedicated to holistic, Waldorf inspired education that engages the whole child. The Board provides guidance and leadership in promoting, supporting and carrying out the mission and long-term vision of Singing Cedars School, working collaboratively with the Faculty and school community. The Board also oversees the following committees: Finance/Development, Outreach & Communication, Buildings & Grounds, Health & Safety.





GILLIAN POPENUCK BOARD PRESIDENT

Gillian Popenuck joined the Board of Singing Cedars in March 2025 and currently serves as President and Chair of the Development Committee. She is also a member of the Finance and Governance Committees. With a background in business management, event planning, and organizational leadership, Gillian brings strong skills in financial management, community cooperation, and team building. She has held numerous community leadership roles and is passionate about fostering connections, engaging people's unique talents, and strengthening community ties to support the school's mission.

As an alumni parent of two grades program students, Gillian is inspired by the school's commitment to nature-based education, fully engaged learning, and its capacity to nurture a deep spiritual connection while raising thoughtful, active citizens. She enjoys homeschooling her three children on their family's homestead, crafting, celebrating the seasons, and hosting gatherings at their biodynamic farm and community space.

LIZ WESTGERDES BOARD VICE PRESIDENT

Elizabeth (Liz) Westgerdes joined the Board of Singing Cedars in 2023 and is currently serving her first year as Vice President. She also chairs the Governance Committee and serves on the Finance Committee. With over twelve years of experience as a Business Analyst in the clinical trials, finance, and agrotech industries, Liz now serves as a Senior Business Analyst at FoodChain ID. In this role, she partners with senior leadership on change management, human-centered design, and strategic visioning, balancing the needs of thousands of users with regulatory requirements, executive direction, and development costs. Liz brings expertise in organizational communication, collaborative decision-making, and strategic planning to her service on the board.

As a wife, mother, and community member, Liz is inspired by Singing Cedars' mission to foster learning and connection. She holds a B.A. with honors from the University of Chicago and an M.A. from Williams College. Outside of her professional work and board service, she enjoys art and gardening.



JENN RICH BOARD TREASURER

Jenn Rich joined the board in October 2023 and currently serves as the Treasurer. She brings over a decade of experience as a small business owner and retail manager, with expertise in sustainable living, business operations, and creating environments that foster community and connection.

Jenn has two children who have attended Singing Cedars since 2023, and is deeply aligned with the school's mission to provide holistic, Waldorf-inspired education that emphasizes both nature and beauty. Beyond her board service, she is an avid runner and enjoys sewing, knitting, and creating handmade toys for her children.

ROBIN GOLDEN BOARD SECRETARY

Robin Golden joined the board of Singing Cedars in August of 2022 and currently serves as board secretary and chair of Outreach and Communications. Robin holds her Doctorate in Physical Therapy contributing to the board in health advocacy as well as understanding of child and adolescent development. She also has a strong background in team-based problem solving bringing a collaborative mindset to the board.

Robin and her husband, Michael, are parents to 3 children, two of whom are Singing Cedars alumni and one currently in early childhood. Associated with singing cedars for more than a decade, Robin believes in education that respects the rhythms of childhood, fosters imagination, and prepares students not just academically, but socially and ethically as well. Robin enjoys supporting her children in extracurricular activities as well as traveling, running, and reading.





RICHARD GLATZ

Richard Glatz joined the Board of Directors in February 2025 as a dedicated supporter of Waldorf inspired education and a parent of two students at Singing Cedars. Drawn to the school's nature-based, child-centered approach, he was inspired by the care, reverence, and intentionality with which students are met each day. Watching his own children thrive in this environment motivated him to help steward and support the school for the benefit of other families in the community.

Richard holds a Ph.D. in Philosophy and has experience teaching both at the college level and in a games-based, analytical thinking skills curriculum for school-aged children in Singapore. He now works in tech as an ontologist, bringing his strengths in conceptual design and information processing to his role on the board.

He's especially passionate about supporting Singing Cedars in establishing a firm and healthy basis for growth, laying the same kind of thoughtful foundation for the school that the curriculum provides for the children it serves. Outside of work and board service, Richard enjoys cooking and baking, engaging in many things nerdy (especially playful, imaginative games), and being unapologetically goofy, silly, and joyfully ridiculous with his family.

ALEA LOBDELL

Alea Lobdell joined the Board of Singing Cedars in 2021 and currently serves as a member of the Outreach & Communication Committee. She holds a B.A. in Human Development with an emphasis in Women & Children's Health Studies from Prescott College and is a Certified Massage Therapist. Alea has worked as a birth doula, birth photographer, and midwife assistant for over a decade, and also brings professional experience in marketing, admissions, customer service, and retail management. Her background reflects a deep commitment to women's health, education, and community care.

All three of Alea's children have attended Singing Cedars over the span of 13 years, and she feels passionate about the gifts of Waldorf inspired education. She has lived in Fairfield for 16 years and enjoys hiking, yoga and pilates, art in all forms, reading, writing, and baking with her children. She also loves visiting Arizona, her second home, and traveling whenever possible.





GRACE GRIFFIN

Grace Griffin joined the Board in 2021 and currently as a member of the Outreach & Communication Committee and Health & Safety Committee and served as Vice President from 2021-2025. Grace is a public health nurse and she brings expertise in health education, community well-being, and compassionate care to her board work. As an alumni parent and mother of four, Grace has been deeply connected to the school community for many years and is inspired by its nurturing environment and commitment to holistic education.

SINGING CEDARS SCHOOL

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